

 **GRACE
LEE BOGGS**
*multi-movement social
justice organizer*

**“Begin by doing
small things at the
local level. That is
how change takes
place in living
systems, not from
above but from within,
from many local
actions occurring
simultaneously”**

MY NAME IS AMANDA and i
made this zine because i am a
volunteer organizer in my spare
time (what's left over after
doing paid work to survive). i've
spent 4 years trying, meeting,
discussing, emailing, studying,
holding space, calling bullshit,
and building relationships with
my neighbors, and i am still
learning how to impact my
surroundings.

let's connect. email me:
a.r.huckins@gmail.com

BEGIN by doing small things

ENCOURAGEMENT TO INTERRUPT POWER
starting now, where you already are.



you have permission to:

- ◆ see your work as part
of an interconnected
whole
- ◆ get inspiration from
what you see
happening in other
places, no matter
how different they
seem compared to
where you are
- ◆ start small (and stay
small if you want!)
- ◆ start now

**“The kind of role that
I tried to play was to
pick up pieces or put
together pieces out
of which I hoped
organization might
come. My theory is,
strong people don't
need strong leaders.”**

 **ELLA BAKER**
*organizer of non-
hierarchical leadership in
Black Liberation*

you have permission to:

- ◆ be inefficient
- ◆ slowly gather
what you need
- ◆ get to know people
deeply and try to
understand them
(and yourself)
- ◆ feed many possibilities
- ◆ use your values
(instead of a
specific end goal)
as your guide

you have permission to:

- ◆ say what you feel is true
to anyone
- ◆ draw strength from
your identity and
experience
- ◆ demand answers and
explanations from
people in power
- ◆ feel confident that the
work you do with
your community
will result in
meaningful change

**“Fear not, the
power is in you.
The problems that
we have are not going
to end if we continue
being afraid.”**

 **MAGDA
RAMIREZ
CASTAÑEDA**
*Chicana cultural and
anti-gentrification
activist*

VERY SHORT BIOGRAPHIES
of organizers quoted in this zine

Ella Baker was a purposefully behind-the-scenes leader of the Black Liberation movement. She advocated for participatory (instead of representative) democracy & mentored young organizers (in the Student Non-violent Coordinating Committee) throughout the 60's

Madonna Thunder Hawk was part of the American Indian Movement (AIM) as an organizer, a facilitator of an improvised and revolutionary "survival school"/ group home on her family's land in South Dakota, and continues to lead resistance as part of the Lakota People's Law Project.

GRASSROOTS ORGANIZING
requires skills, but you already have the most important ones.

you just have to care deeply (which you do) and be willing to work closely with other people who care deeply.

you will need to offer at least one of your talents to the public good, which means that you have to acknowledge your ability to make a meaningful contribution. and that's all you need to start.

want more permission?

the following pages contain ways to start from the lives of experienced organizers.

Grace Lee Boggs spent 80 years in movement activism, from tenant's and labor rights, to civil rights, to neighborhood self-determination (in Detroit), to anti-war and ecological justice struggles.

Delores Lintel started organizing over coffee around her kitchen table in Lincoln, NE's Clinton neighborhood, whose self-advocacy organization she helped found.

Magda Ramirez Castañeda was a Chicana organizer and longtime resident of Chicago's Pilsen Neighborhood. Starting in the late 90's she became a leading voice against gentrification there.

"We didn't have any idea of what was happening or why... but we decided that we would have to take responsibility for our neighborhood... At each meeting we'd kind of figure out what was the most pressing issue... We just chugged along trying to manage to do something about what was happening to us. We just did what we had to do."

DELORES LINTEL
neighborhood organizer in Lincoln, NE

you have permission to:

- ◆ organize around your own life, needs, and communities
- ◆ create new ways of organizing that suit you better than what you've seen done
- ◆ root your organizing/ change-making in your dearest responsibilities
- ◆ prioritize the ideas and thoughts of children!

"It was a movement of people, and that meant elders and children, families. So whenever we decided to go anywhere, everybody was involved that wanted to be involved and have a say so"

"It would've been easier for me to travel around and play militant and stick my kids in school, and let someone else take care of them. But...we had our own school, because that's what my children wanted."

MADONNA THUNDER HAWK
organizer of grassroots indigenous resistance

you have permission to:

- ◆ act without having all the information you wish you had
- ◆ step to leadership (and back again, as needed)
- ◆ think on your feet, improvise, reassess, and modify your approach
- ◆ try something, even if there are reasons it might not work how you want